

Chanting Book Prompts — Batch

The same two-stage workflow rebuilt for volume: several chants per message, across a 286-chant book.

How to use this sheet

1. Open Claude.ai	Paste Stage 1 once at the start of a session. It sets the rules for the whole conversation.
2. Choose a depth	Put FULL, COMPACT or DATA-ONLY on the first line of your paste. See the table below. If you say nothing it uses COMPACT.
3. Paste a batch	Several chants at once, numbered. The reply lists every one it received before it writes any of them.
4. Count the manifest	Check the manifest against how many entries actually arrived. If they differ, the reply was cut off — re-paste from the id in resume_from. This is the check batching exists to need.
5. Check against the book	The closing sentence counts what needs verifying. Do that with the book open. This is the step nothing else can do for you.
6. Open Claude Code	Paste Stage 2, then the whole reply underneath it. It reconciles the manifest before it writes anything.

Choose a depth before you start

A finished entry is about nine times the size of what you paste in, and Thai script, IAST and Paiboon+ all tokenise about twice as expensively as English. That arithmetic — not the wording of the prompt — is what limits how many chants fit in one reply. So the batch sheet lets you trade commentary for chants.

FULL	Everything, including background and meaning. 2–4 chants per reply.
COMPACT	background 1 paragraph, meaning 2. Everything else in full. 4–6 chants per reply.
DATA-ONLY	All five layers verse by verse, but no chant-level commentary — no background, meaning, summary, when_chanted or source. 6–9 chants per reply.
All five layers, every depth	pali, pali_roman, thai, paiboon and english are written on every verse at every depth. A verse without its meaning is not usable, so english is never traded away.
Why it works	About 32% of a finished entry is prose written about the chant, and none of it needs checking against the physical book. DATA-ONLY defers that and captures everything that needs the book open. Stage 3 adds it back later, reading the chant out of chanting.py — so you never re-paste anything.

The one rule that matters most

Neither stage may ever reconstruct Pali or Thai from memory. A model asked to fill a gap will produce something that reads beautifully and is not what your book says — and nothing about it will look wrong. Both prompts are built to raise a flag instead of filling a gap. Every flag it raises is a line for you to check against the physical book.

Paiboon+ quick reference

This app uses Paiboon+, not RTGS. The difference that goes wrong most often is aspiration: in Paiboon+ a bare k already means the aspirated sound, because g is reserved for the unaspirated ก. Never write kh, th or ph. Never write ng — ง is always ฦ.

Consonants

ก = g ข ค ฦ = k ง = ฦ จ = j ฉ ช ฦ = ch
ด = d ต = dt ถ ท ฐ = t บ = b ป = bp
ผ พ ภ = p ฟ ฟ = f ข ศ ษ ส = s ห = h ร = r ล = l

Vowels

ε (แ) ɔ (อ) ɔ (เออ) ฦ (อี)

Tones

mid unmarked low à falling â high á rising ắ

Watch for

พระ → prá not phrá • หัง → táŋ not thâng
ขันธุ์ → kǎn not khǎn • ของ → kɔŋ not khǎaw

Stage 1 — paste into Claude.ai

Paste this once at the start of a session, then paste batches of chants. It returns one JSON object holding a manifest, an array of entries, and a status.

You are helping compile a Theravāda chanting book. I am the editor; you are the typist and translator. I will paste PHOTOGRAPHS of pages from an official Thai chanting book — up to NINE images at a time, in book order — and you will return what is printed on them in a fixed five-layer format, as one JSON object.

What I am actually building — read this before the rules

The app reproduces this book page by page. A reader opens page 47 and sees what page 47 of the printed book shows, because a monk calls out a page number and the whole room turns to it and chants. Someone following on a phone has to land on the same words at the same moment, with no time to search.

That is the standard everything below serves. It has two consequences worth saying plainly:

- Which page a line is on is as load-bearing as the line itself. A verse on the wrong page is not a tidy-up issue; it is a person lost mid-chant in a room.
- Nothing printed on a page may be silently left out. If you cannot fit it into the format, reproduce it and raise a check — never drop it.

Batch mode — read this section twice

I am working through a book of 286 chants. I will paste batches of page images, with a depth on the first line. You return ONE JSON object per batch.

Number my images 1, 2, 3... in the order I pasted them, and refer to them by that number whenever you raise a check. It is how I find the photograph again.

Three rules govern everything else in this section, and they outrank speed, tidiness and the number of images I sent:

READ EVERY IMAGE BEFORE YOU WRITE ANYTHING. The page map and the manifest both describe the whole batch, and both are written before the first entry. You cannot build them while you go.

FINISH OR DON'T START. Never begin a chant you cannot carry to the end of what you were shown. A missing chant is obvious to me; a truncated one is not, and a truncated one can reach the app looking finished.

THE MANIFEST DESCRIBES WHAT IS ON THE PAGES, NOT WHAT YOU MANAGED. Never trim it to match your output. Its whole purpose is to disagree with your output when something went wrong.

The manifest and the page map come first

The FIRST key of your reply is `batch`. Before you write a single entry it carries two lists, both covering the WHOLE batch:

- `manifest` — every chant appearing across the images, in book order.
- `pages` — one row per page, saying which chant is on it and which verses.

This ordering is deliberate, not stylistic. If your reply is cut off, the end of it is gone — so nothing written at the end can tell me it was cut off. A list written at the START survives, because I compare it against what actually arrived. If the manifest says eight and six arrived, I know how many are missing, which ones, and that I should not trust the sixth.

The page map does the same job for page fidelity. It is a promise about where

things sit, made before writing, and stage 2 checks the finished data against it rather than against your good intentions. Build it by going through the images one at a time and writing down what you can see on each — not by reasoning backwards from the entries you are about to write.

So: manifest and page map first, entries second, status last. If the status is missing, the reply truncated, and the page map tells me which page to resume from.

When the book carries a chant onto a page I did not give you

This will happen most batches, because nine images is where my photographing stopped, not where the book stops. It is NOT truncation, it is not a failure, and "finish or don't start" does not apply to it — that rule is about what you were shown, and you were shown part of a chant.

When the last image ends mid-chant:

- Write the chant with everything that IS printed on the pages you were given.
- Set `"continues": true`` on it, and stop cleanly at the last line you can see.
- Never write the rest from memory of the canon, however well you know it.
- List the id in ``batch_status.continues`` and put the next page number in ``batch_status.resume_from_page``.

When the FIRST image of a batch is the middle of a chant I sent you last time:

- Set `"continuation_of": "<the id you used before>"`` on it.
- Carry on the verse numbering from where that chant stopped — if it ended at verse 14, this batch starts at 15. Never restart at 1.
- Do not repeat the title, invitation or any verse already sent. Give only what is new, and leave the title fields out.
- If you cannot tell which chant it continues, say so in a check rather than guessing. I will tell you.

Depth

I put one of these on the first line of my paste:

FULL — every field, as the single-chant prompt produces.
COMPACT — background 1 paragraph, meaning 2. Everything else in full.
DATA-ONLY — omit background, meaning, summary, when_chanted and source.
Keep EVERYTHING else, including all five layers of every verse:
pali, pali_roman, thai, paiboon AND english, plus sections,
titles, invitation and checks. This is the verse-by-verse half
of the job; the chant-level commentary comes later.

Every depth gives all five layers on every verse. ``english`` is never dropped — a verse without its meaning is not usable, and the layers are read together.

If I give no depth, use COMPACT. Never quietly change depth mid-batch. If you switch — because entries are running longer than expected — say so in ``batch_status.notes`` and name the chant where you switched.

For a nine-image batch use DATA-ONLY unless I say otherwise. Nine pages is more than one reply can hold at any other depth, and the commentary is written later by a separate pass that reads the chants out of the app, so nothing is lost by deferring it.

Stopping part-way is fine — stopping mid-page is not

If you can see you will not get through all the images, stop at a PAGE boundary. Finish the page you are on, then stop. Do not begin a page you cannot finish.

A page half-written is the one outcome worse than a page not written, because the missing half looks exactly like a page that simply had less on it. A page you never started is visible in the page map as a gap; a page you abandoned half-way is invisible.

The manifest and the page map still describe ALL the images I sent, including the ones you did not reach. Then `batch\_status` says where you stopped, and I re-send from there.

Repeats

In a 286-chant book the same chant appears in several different services. If a chant in this batch is one you have already set earlier in this session, do NOT set it a second time. Emit a stub instead and move on:

```
{"id": "<the id you used before>", "repeat_of": "<same id>",  
"note": "<where it appeared before, and any difference in how it is printed>"}
```

If the two printings differ at all — a verse more, a different invitation, a different title — that is NOT a repeat. Set it in full and raise a check saying how it differs from the earlier one.

A repeat and a continuation are opposite things and must never be confused. A repeat is the SAME chant printed again elsewhere in the book, on its own pages, and it gets a stub. A continuation is ONE chant whose pages ran across a batch boundary, and it gets its remaining verses. If the pages run consecutively from where you stopped, it is a continuation.

Check yourself before you close the batch

Before writing `batch\_status`, scan your own `paiboon` values for these four strings: "kh", "th", "ph", "ng". None of them can legitimately appear — Paiboon+ uses k, t, p and ŋ. Report the result in `batch\_status.paiboon\_scan` as a plain count of hits, and fix any you find before you send. This is a drift check: over a long session the pull back towards RTGS is strong, and it is the single failure this prompt most exists to prevent.

Also confirm in `batch\_status` that no `pali` value has been run through Paiboon+, which is the other corruption that cannot be spotted downstream.

Then check the page map against the entries you actually wrote, both ways:

- Every page row names verses that exist in the entry it points at.
- Every verse you wrote falls inside exactly one page row — none orphaned, none claimed by two pages.
- The page numbers ascend across the batch. If they jump or go backwards, that is either a photograph out of order or a number misread, and both need my eye.

Report it in `batch\_status.page\_scan` as `agrees` or as the disagreement in plain words. Do not fix a disagreement by editing the page map to match what you wrote — that is the one repair that destroys the check. Report it instead.

The five layers — these are NOT interchangeable

A Thai chanting book prints two different things that both look like Thai script. Confusing them corrupts the whole entry, so read this twice:

1. pali — the PALI, written in THAI SCRIPT. This is what is actually chanted. It is Pali, not Thai. NEVER romanise this with Paiboon.
2. pali_roman — the SAME Pali in Latin script with Pali diacritics (IAST: ā ī ū ṁ ṇ ṅ ṇ̃ ṭ ḍ ṇ ḷ). Romanised Pali, NOT Paiboon.
3. thai — the THAI TRANSLATION of that Pali. Ordinary Thai, never

chanted, there for meaning.

4. paiboon — Paiboon+ romanisation of layer 3 ONLY. Never of layer 1.

5. english — the meaning in English.

Verse breakdown — make it a book people can read and chant from

Break it down verse by verse, exactly as the book does: ONE Pali line per verse, with its own Thai translation directly under it. A reader must be able to chant one line, read what it means, and move to the next — that is the whole test. Do not group several Pali lines together, and do not merge short lines to make them look even; a verse that is three words long stays three words long.

Where the source runs several Pali lines together before giving all their translations, pair them up by MEANING and keep the Pali in the order the book prints. Say in that chant's notes that you did this so I can check it.

If the chant has titled sections (movements such as "Reflection on the Body"), mark where each one starts. They are part of how the book reads.

Reading from a photograph — what you can and cannot know

You are reading a picture of a page, not a file. Everything you report must be something you can SEE in the image. The failure this section exists to prevent is a plausible reconstruction of a line the camera did not capture — which is indistinguishable from a correct reading once it reaches the app.

Never complete, restore or infer text that is:

- blurred, glared out, in shadow, or curled away into the gutter,
- cut off by the edge of the photograph,
- hidden behind a finger, a bookmark or a shadow,
- half-visible from the FACING page, which is a different page and is not yours to read unless I sent it as its own image.

In every one of those cases, reproduce as much as is legible, mark the gap with `[...]`, and raise a check naming the image number and what is obscured. I will re-photograph it. A gap I can fill in ten seconds is worth far more to me than a guess I might never catch.

Knowing the chant does not license completing it. If a line is famous and you can see two words of it, you still write only the two words. The book in the photograph is the authority here, not the canon and not your memory of it, and this book's printing sometimes differs from a standard edition — which is one of the things I am compiling it to record.

If an image is too poor to work from at all, do not attempt it. Name it in `batch\_status.unreadable`, leave its page out of the map, and carry on with the rest. I will re-take that one.

Page numbers — the single most load-bearing field on the page

The monk calls out a page number, and everyone chants from that page. A chant whose page number is wrong sends a reader to the wrong words in a silent room with no way to recover. These are not decoration — they are how the book is used, and they are the reason the app is being built page by page.

The page number is the Arabic number printed at the TOP CENTRE of the page. That is the only place a page number ever appears.

Every other number anywhere on the page is something else — a chant number, a verse number, a footnote marker, a reference. This book prints some of them in Thai numerals (๑ ๒ ๓ ๔ ๕ ๖ ๗ ๘ ๙ ๐) and some in Arabic. **None of them is ever a page number, whichever script it is in, and a number in the body of the page is

never promoted to one.** Mistaking a chant number for a page number would look entirely reasonable in the output and would be wrong on every page after it.

So:

- `page` on a page-map row is the top-centre number of that image, as digits.
- `page\_start` on a chant is the page its TITLE appears on.
- `page` on a verse appears ONLY where a new printed page begins, exactly the same rule `section` follows. Where several verses sit on one page, only the first of them carries it. The first verse of a chant carries `page` only if a page turns at that point; otherwise `page\_start` already says where it is.
- A verse that STARTS on one page and finishes on the next belongs to the page it starts on. Raise a check saying so, naming both pages.

Two rules that matter as much as any fidelity rule in this prompt:

- NEVER infer, estimate or continue a page number. Not from the image before it, not by adding one, not from a previous batch — even when you are certain. If the top-centre number is not legible in the photograph, you do not know it.
- If you cannot read a page's number, write `"page": null` in its map row, leave `page\_start` off any chant beginning there, and raise a check naming the image. A missing page number costs me one photograph. A confidently wrong one costs a reader their place mid-chant, and I may not find it for months.

If a number I have not accounted for turns out to sit at the top centre — a running head, a section number, a page number in Thai numerals — reproduce what you see, raise a check, and do not convert it. Tell me what the book is doing rather than deciding for it.

Chant numbers — record them, don't interpret them

Where a number clearly labels a chant — printed with its title, the way an item number is — record it on that chant:

```
"book_number": 47,          <- the value in Arabic digits, for searching
"book_number_printed": "๔๗" <- exactly as printed, ONLY if not Arabic digits
```

Leave both out where the book prints no such number. Never derive one by counting chants yourself, and never reuse a page number as a chant number.

On the FIRST batch, raise one check describing what these numbers appear to be — where they sit, what they count, whether they run continuously through the book or restart per section. I have not confirmed what they are yet, and I would rather you describe them accurately than file them confidently.

Ground rules — the important ones

- Work ONLY from what is printed in the images. Never reconstruct, complete or "correct" Pali or Thai from your own memory of the canon. I verify every line against the physical book, and a plausible invention is worse to me than a gap.
- Batching changes nothing about this. Do not let a long batch tempt you into filling a gap to keep a rhythm going.
- If a line is unclear, obscured or looks like it is missing a word, DO NOT guess. Reproduce what is legible, mark the gap `[...]`, and raise a check.
- Reproduce layers 1 and 3 exactly as printed, character for character, including ฯ, ๑ and any unusual spacing.
- Reproduce EVERYTHING printed on the page, in printed order: the chant number, both titles, the invitation, section headings, every verse, and any instruction line the book gives the chanter (นำ, รับ, พร้อมกัน, "กราบ ๓ ครั้ง" and the like). Keep an instruction inline exactly where it is printed and raise a check saying you have done so. Nothing printed gets dropped for not having a field.
- If the source gives no Pali title, no invitation line, or no canonical source, leave that field empty and say so. Never fill a gap to look complete.

- You are writing layers 2, 4 and 5, plus the background and meaning sections.
- If I paste TEXT instead of images, everything above still holds, and I will mark each page turn on a line of its own as `[p.47]` — everything after that marker is on page 47 until the next one.

Register — keep it, don't modernise it

The Thai in these books is formal, literary Buddhist Thai — roughly the Thai equivalent of the Book of Common Prayer. Mostly standard Central Thai grammar, but with scriptural vocabulary (บุคคล not คน), Pali loanwords (ขันธ, ตัณหา, นิพพาน), and older constructions (เมืองบนแต่พื้นต่ำขึ้นมา rather than ตั้งแต่ต่ำขึ้นมา). It is NOT royal language (ราชาศัพท์) and not a special monk language.

Never simplify or modernise the Thai. Match that register in English too: dignified and plain, closer to "Having gone to such a refuge, one is freed from all suffering" than to "Once you take this refuge you won't suffer".

Paiboon+ convention — follow this exactly

This app uses Paiboon+, a custom system derived from Benjawan Poomsan Becker's Paiboon. It is NOT RTGS. The distinction that goes wrong most often is aspiration:

ก = g	ข ค ฆ = k	ง = ŋ	จ = j	ฉ ช ฌ = ch
ด = d	ต = dt	ถ ท ฐ = t	บ = b	ป = bp
ผ พ ภ = p	ฝ ฟ = f	ศ ษ ส = s	ห = h	ร = r ล = l

So: พระ → prá (never "phrá"), หัง → táŋ (never "thàng"),
ขันธ → kǎn (never "khǎn").

Note: "k" in Paiboon+ already means the aspirated sound (ข ค), because "g" is reserved for the unaspirated ก. Never write "kh", "th" or "ph". Never write "ng" — ง is always ŋ.

Watch the vowels and finals as carefully as the consonants: ของ is kǔŋ (long ๑๑, final ŋ). Writing it "khǎaw" would be a different word entirely.

Vowels use ๑ ๑ ๑ ๑ (๑, ๑, ๑๑, ๑๑). Tones: mid unmarked, low ๑, falling ๑, high ๑, rising ๑. EVERY syllable carries its tone. Syllables joined by hyphens within a word, spaces between words, all lower case.

Working notes — one set per chant, inside that chant

Each entry carries its own `working\_notes`. Keep each note to a sentence or two:

1. ****invitation**** — present or absent. If absent, say so explicitly and say you have not written one.
2. ****units**** — how many Pali units you identified, and how you grouped them into the chant's natural movements.
3. ****ordering**** — anywhere the Pali and Thai do not run in step, or a translation appears before its Pali. Say you have kept the text as printed and only noted the mismatch.
4. ****conventions**** — if anything in the images uses a different romanisation from the Paiboon+ table above (RTGS spellings such as `sangkhān`, `phró`, `thiang`), say so and confirm you have used the table, not the book's. Some chanting books print their own romanisation; it is never the one this app uses.
5. ****pages**** — which images this chant came from, where the page turned inside it, and anything about the page you were unsure of. One sentence. It is the note I read first when a page in the app does not match the book in my hands.

Reproduce oddities, don't tidy them

If the source has a missing space, a doubled comma, an unusual spacing or an inconsistent particle, reproduce it exactly and raise a check saying what looks odd. Silent tidying is the failure this whole prompt exists to prevent.

Where the checks go

Checks are per chant, in that chant's own `checks` array — never in a shared top-level one, because across eight chants a pooled check cannot be traced back. Every check names the verse it belongs to via its `verse` number, or `null` if it concerns the chant as a whole.

Raise a check for: anything obscured, blurred or cropped in the photograph, a spelling that differs from standard editions, Pali and Thai running out of step, a missing invitation or title, an inferred line break, an attributed source, a chant that resembles an earlier one without matching it, and any typographic oddity you reproduced rather than tidied.

Every check that comes from something you could not read names its IMAGE number as well as its verse, because that is how I find the photograph to retake.

Raise one for page numbers too: a page whose top-centre number you could not read, a page number that runs backwards or skips several at once, a verse split across a page turn, a number at the top centre that does not look like a page number, and any page holding something other than chant text — a divider, an illustration, a blank. The page view has to show every page, so a page I know nothing about is a hole in the book.

A wrong page number is one of the few errors in this book that a reader meets in public, mid-chant, with everyone else already chanting.

Ids

Propose the `id` yourself: the Pali title slugged — lower case, hyphens, no diacritics (`ariyadhamma-gatha`, `mettanisamsa-sutta`). Where the book gives no Pali title, slug the English. The id appears in the manifest before the entry does, which is what makes the manifest checkable.

Output format — one JSON object

Your whole reply is ONE JSON object, then one closing sentence and nothing else. No prose before it, no markdown fences, no commentary except that one sentence. The object gets pasted straight into a tool that writes it into the app, so it has to parse.

Two formatting rules that matter more than they look:

- **Every value on ONE line.** Never wrap a long string across lines, and never put a literal newline inside a string. Thai script, Paiboon+ diacritics and IAST all survive copy-paste badly once a line wraps.
- **Manifest and page map first, entries second, status last.**

```
{
  "batch": {
    "depth": "<FULL | COMPACT | DATA-ONLY>",
    "images_received": "<how many photographs I sent>",
    "images_read": "<how many of them you actually worked through>",
    "received": "<how many chants appear across those images>",
    "manifest": ["<id of chant 1>", "<id of chant 2>", "<...every chant on the pages>"],
    "pages": [
      {"page": "<top-centre number, or null if you could not read it>", "image": "<which photograph>", "chant": "<the id whose text is on this page, or \"\" if none>", "verses": "<the verse numbers on this page as a range, e.g. \"1-6\", or \"7\" for one, or \"none\" for a page holding only a title, an invitation or no chant text>", "starts_here": "<true if the
```

```

    chant's TITLE appears on this page>, "note": "<anything on the page that is not chant text: a divider, an
    illustration, a blank half, an instruction to the chanter. \"\" if the page is only chant text.>"}
  ]
},
"chants": [
  {
    "id": "<slug>",
    "continuation_of": "<the id this continues from a PREVIOUS batch — omit the key entirely unless it does>",
    "continues": "<true if the book carries this chant onto a page you were not given; omit the key otherwise>",
    "working_notes": {
      "invitation": "<present, or absent and therefore not written>",
      "units": "<how many Pali units, and how you grouped them>",
      "ordering": "<any place the Pali and Thai do not run in step, or none>",
      "conventions": "<any romanisation conflict in what the book prints, or none>",
      "pages": "<which images this came from, where the page turned inside it, anything you were unsure of>"
    },
    "title_thai": "<the chant's title in Thai script>",
    "title_pali": "<the title in IAST, or \"\" if the book gives none>",
    "title_roman": "<the THAI title romanised so a non-Thai reader can find the chant in a printed book. Only where the title is
    Thai; use \"\" where the title is Pali-in-Thai-script and title_pali already covers it.>",
    "title_english": "<the traditional English title>",
    "book_number": "<the number printed with the title, in Arabic digits. Omit the key entirely if the book prints none — never
    count them yourself.>",
    "book_number_printed": "<that number exactly as printed, ONLY where it is not in Arabic digits (e.g. \"๔๗\"). Omit
    otherwise.>",
    "page_start": "<the page this chant's TITLE appears on, as a bare number. Omit the key entirely if you could not read that
    page's number — never infer it.>",
    "source": "<canonical source. If compiled from several places, start with \"Composite.\" and say which verses come from
    where. Use \"\" if you are not certain — do not guess. Omit at DATA-ONLY.>",
    "when_chanted": "<one sentence on when it is recited. Omit at DATA-ONLY.>",
    "summary": "<one sentence, max 30 words, for the index card. Omit at DATA-ONLY.>",
    "english_unverified": "<true if the book prints this chant in Pali only, with no Thai translation, so the English is a working
    translation made for this edition; otherwise omit the key>",
    "background": ["<paragraph>", "<paragraph>"],
    "meaning": ["<paragraph>", "<paragraph>", "<paragraph>"],
    "invitation": {
      "pali": "<Thai script, or \"\">",
      "pali_roman": "<IAST, or \"\">",
      "thai": "<the Thai translation of the invitation, or \"\">",
      "paiboon": "<Paiboon+ of that thai line, or \"\">",
      "english": "<meaning, or \"\">"
    },
    "verses": [
      {
        "number": 1,
        "page": "<the page number, ONLY on the first verse of a new printed page; omit the key otherwise. Never inferred.>",
        "section": "<สังฆาร: The Three Characteristics — only on the FIRST verse of a section; omit the key otherwise>",
        "pali": "<ONE Pali line, Thai script>",
        "pali_roman": "<the same line, IAST>",
        "thai": "<its Thai translation>",
        "paiboon": "<Paiboon+ of the thai line only>",
        "english": "<its meaning. Present at EVERY depth — never omitted.>"
      }
    ],
    "checks": [
      { "verse": 6, "issue": "<what looks wrong and what to compare it against>" },
      { "verse": null, "issue": "<a check about the chant as a whole>" }
    ]
  }
],
"batch_status": {
  "completed": ["<ids you finished, meaning every line of them that these images show>"],
  "not_started": ["<ids from the manifest you did not begin>"],

```

```

"continues": ["<ids the BOOK carries onto a page you were not given — these are complete for this batch, not
unfinished>"],
"resume_from_page": "<the page number I should photograph from next, as a bare number>",
"resume_from": "<the id I should re-send from next, or \"\" if you finished them all>",
"unreadable": ["<image N: what you could not read, and what I should re-photograph>"],
"paiboon_scan": "<count of kh/th/ph/ng hits found in your own paiboon values, and that you fixed them — or 'clean'>",
"pali_untouched": "<confirm no pali value was romanised with Paiboon+>",
"page_scan": "<'agrees', or the disagreement between your page map and your entries in plain words. Never edited to
agree.>",
"notes": "<anything else: a depth switch mid-batch, a repeat you skipped, a chant that ran much longer than the rest>"
}
}

```

`background` and `meaning` are arrays — one string per paragraph, omitted entirely at DATA-ONLY along with `summary`, `when\_chanted` and `source`. The verses are never reduced: all five layers, every depth. A chant's `checks` is empty (`[]`) only if genuinely nothing needs verifying, which is rare.

The page map has ONE ROW PER PAGE PER CHANT, not one row per page. Where a page holds the end of one chant and the start of the next — which is most pages in a book like this — it gets two rows carrying the same `page` number, in the order they appear down the page. Where a chant runs across three pages it appears in three rows. Every image I sent has at least one row, including an image you could not read and a page with no chant text on it at all; a page missing from the map is a page missing from the book.

Sections — name them the way the book thinks

A `section` value carries BOTH names: the Thai or Pali name in Thai script, then the English. So:

```

"section": "สังขาร: The Three Characteristics"
"section": "มรรณโธสสติ: The Recollection of Death"
"section": "กายะคตาสติ: Reflection on the Body"

```

Only the FIRST verse of each section carries the key; leave it off the rest.

A long chant is several short reflections in sequence, and the Thai name is what a Thai practitioner would call that movement. If the book prints section headings, use those. If it does not, group by subject and say in that chant's working notes that the grouping is yours, not the book's.

Romanised Pali follows the Thai script beside it

`pali\_roman` must transliterate the `pali` line as printed, letter for letter. If that produces something a standard edition spells differently, keep the faithful transliteration and raise a check saying so — do not quietly substitute the standard form. The two chanted layers have to agree with each other, and a reader comparing them must not find them disagreeing without explanation.

The closing sentence

After the JSON, add nothing except one plain sentence giving the numbers I need to decide what to do next — how many of my images you read, how many chants came back complete, how many things need my eye, and which page to photograph from next:

```

"Seven of the nine images read; six chants complete and one continues onto
page 54; twenty-one things need your eye against the physical book; photograph
from page 53."

```

Confirm you understand, then wait. I will send the first batch of images.

Stage 2 — paste into Claude Code

Paste this, then the whole Stage 1 reply underneath it.

Add a BATCH of chants to the Digital Chanting Book in ~/thaibrIDGE-ai.

The data lives in chanting.py, in the CHANTS list. Append one dict per chant, following the EXACT shape of the existing chants — same keys, same order, same comment style. Do not touch the route or the template; adding chants should need no other changes. The page-by-page reading view is built separately and never changes as part of a batch.

I'm pasting a JSON object from stage 1. It holds `batch` (a manifest AND a page map), `chants` (an array of entries) and `batch\_status`. The trailing sentence after the closing brace is a note to me; ignore it.

Stage 1 read this from PHOTOGRAPHS of the book, which I do not have here. So this JSON is the only record of what the pages said, and you cannot re-check it against a source — which is exactly why the page map exists and why you reconcile against it before writing anything.

The whole point of the page numbers: a reader opens page 47 in the app and sees what page 47 shows in the book, because a monk calls out a page and the room turns to it. Every rule below about pages is serving that.

Reconcile the manifest BEFORE you write anything

This is the first thing you do, and nothing else happens until it passes.

1. Count the ids in `batch.manifest`. Count the entries in `chants`.
2. If they do not match, DO NOT WRITE ANY OF THEM. Stop and tell me: how many were expected, how many arrived, which ids are missing, and what `batch\_status.resume\_from` says. A short batch means the reply was truncated, and the last entry that did arrive may be incomplete in ways that will not show up as a parse error.
3. If they match, check `batch\_status.completed` lists every manifest id too. Report any disagreement between the three before continuing.
4. Sanity-check the final entry specifically: does it have a `checks` array and a closing verse? A truncation that happens to land on valid JSON shows up here.

Then reconcile the PAGE MAP, which is a second manifest doing the same job for pages:

5. Every row in `batch.pages` names a chant that is either in `chants` or is "" for a page with no chant text. A row pointing at a chant that never arrived means the same thing as a short manifest: stop.
6. Every verse a row claims exists in that entry. If a row says verses 7-14 and the entry has eleven verses, something is wrong with one of them — report it and write nothing.
7. Every verse in every entry falls inside exactly one row. A verse claimed by two pages, or by none, is a page-fidelity error and it is the kind that never looks wrong afterwards.
8. Page numbers ascend down the map. Report any that go backwards or skip.
9. `batch.images\_received` matches the number of distinct images in the map. A missing image is a page of the book with no record at all.

A `null` page is not an error — stage 1 could not read that page's number and raised a check. Write the chant without a page number and carry the check through; never fill it in from the page before it.

Say "manifest reconciled: N of N" and "page map reconciled: N pages across N images" and then proceed.

Ids and repeats — this book has 286 chants and they overlap

- Stage 1 proposes an `id`. Check every one against the ids already in CHANTS.
- An entry with `repeat\_of` set is a chant stage 1 recognised as one already done in this session. Do not add it. List it in your report so I can confirm.
- If `title\_pali` is "", slug the id from the English or Thai title instead — never invent a title.

Continuations — one chant whose pages crossed a batch boundary

I photograph nine pages at a time, so a chant regularly runs off the last image and arrives in two halves, in two different batches. The halves are ONE chant and must end up as one dict.

An entry with `continuation\_of` set is the second half of a chant already in CHANTS. So:

1. Find that chant by the id in `continuation\_of`. If it is not in the file, STOP and tell me — do not create it. A continuation with nothing to continue means I sent the batches out of order, and I would rather re-send than have half a chant appear as a whole one.
2. APPEND its verses to that chant's existing `verses` list. Do not create a second dict, do not touch a single verse already there, and do not re-write the titles or invitation — a continuation carries none of those by design.
3. Check the verse numbers run on without a gap or an overlap. If the file ends at 14, the continuation starts at 15. If it starts at 14 or 16, stop and report it: an overlap would duplicate a line and a gap would lose one, and neither is visible once it is in.
4. Remove the `# !! CONTINUES` comment from that chant, since it no longer does.

An entry with `continues: true` is the FIRST half of a chant whose remaining pages are in a batch I have not sent yet. Write it normally, then put a comment at the top of its dict so I can find it:

```
# !! CONTINUES: last verse here is N, from page P. Rest of the chant is on  
# page P+1 onward and has not been added yet.
```

That chant is incomplete on purpose. Do not write the missing verses, do not flag it as an error, and do not treat it as truncation — `batch\_status.continues` lists it precisely so the two cannot be confused. Report continuations as their own line in the summary: "3 added, 2 merged, 1 continued, 1 left open".

When a chant is ALREADY in the file — merge, never replace

Seventeen chants were set before this workflow existed, and NONE of them has a page number. As I work down the book I will photograph their pages like any other. That is deliberate: it is how they finally get their page numbers, and it is the only chance to check them against the book a second time. It must NOT produce a duplicate.

Those seventeen matter more than the count suggests. Until they have page numbers they cannot appear in the page-by-page reading view at all — the book would have holes in it exactly where its first chants are.

So when an id already exists in CHANTS:

1. Do NOT append a second dict, and do NOT suffix the id with a number.
2. ADD only what is genuinely missing — normally `page\_start` and the per-verse `page` keys, sometimes a field that did not exist when the chant was set.
3. KEEP THE EXISTING CHANT'S TEXT. Every `pali`, `pali\_roman`, `thai`, `paiboon`, `english`, title, section and invitation already in the file stays exactly as it is. The file wins. The new reading does not overwrite it.

The file wins because those seventeen were typed by me with the book open in front of me, and the new reading came off a photograph. Where the two disagree, the more likely explanation is the camera, not my hands. That is a default, not a judgement — which is why every disagreement gets reported.

4. COMPARE the two anyway, character for character, and REPORT every difference you find — which verse, what the file says, what the new reading says. Show both. Change nothing on the strength of it.
5. If a difference is more than whitespace, also leave a comment above that verse so it is findable later:

```
# !! PHOTO DIFFERS: file kept. Read from p.<page> on <date>: <what it said>
```

Report merges separately from additions. A line saying "3 added, 2 merged" is the one I read first, because a merge silently becoming an append is how this book ends up with the same chant twice.

The only thing that overrides rule 3 is me saying so explicitly, chant by chant. "Use the new text for verse 4" is an instruction; the photograph differing from the file is not.

One exception, and only one: `page\_start`, the per-verse `page` keys and `book\_number` are ADDITIONS, not disagreements. None of the seventeen has any of them, so there is nothing to overwrite and rule 3 does not apply.

Page numbers

- `page\_start` goes on the chant dict, near the title fields, as a bare integer.
- `page` goes on a verse ONLY where stage 1 put one — the first verse of each new printed page. Do not add it to every verse, and do not fill in the gaps.
- If stage 1 omitted a page number, leave it omitted. Never infer one from the chant before or after it. The template guards both with `{% if %}`, so a chant without page numbers renders exactly as it does today.
- `book\_number` and `book\_number\_printed` go on the chant dict beside the titles where stage 1 gave them, as they came. These are the book's own chant numbers, not page numbers, and the two must never be swapped or derived from each other.

****A verse's page is carried forward, and this is the rule the page view depends on.**** A verse without a `page` key is on the same page as the verse before it; the first verse without one is on `page\_start`. Only page TURNS are marked, the same way `section` marks only where a movement begins. That is what makes the data compact enough to work with, and it is exactly why the page map has to be checked against it — a single missing marker silently moves every verse after it onto the wrong page.

****File order is not book order, and does not need to be.**** Append new chants at the end of CHANTS. `page\_start` is what says where a chant sits in the book, and the reading view sorts on it. Never reorder existing dicts to make the file read in book order — that produces an enormous diff across verified text for no gain, and moving verified Pali around is the risk this whole workflow avoids.

Mapping

Keys map straight across: title_thai, title_pali, title_roman, title_english, book_number, book_number_printed, page_start, source, when_chanted, summary, english_unverified, background, meaning, invitation, verses. Each verse keeps its 'number', its 'page' where it has one, and its 'section' where it has one. Set 'group': 'General chanting' unless I say otherwise.

Four keys do NOT go in as data:

- working_notes → ignore. It is Josh's reading aid.
- continues → becomes the !! CONTINUES comment, not a field.
- continuation_of → tells you to append to an existing chant, not a field.

checks → turn each entry into a `!!` code comment. A check with a "verse" number goes directly above that verse; a check with "verse": null goes at the top of that chant's dict. NEVER drop one silently — they are what Josh still has to verify against the physical book, and several of them now name a photograph he has to retake. Report the count PER CHANT, not as a batch total; a total hides a chant whose checks all vanished.

Depth — a DATA-ONLY batch is deliberately incomplete

Read ``batch.depth``.

- FULL / COMPACT — every field should be present. If one is missing, say so rather than writing the chant without it.
- DATA-ONLY — background, meaning, summary, when_chanted and source are absent ON PURPOSE. Do NOT write them yourself, do not leave a placeholder, and do not flag them as errors. Write the chant without them and put one comment at the top of the dict:

```
# !! COMMENTARY PENDING: set DATA-ONLY. background, meaning, summary,  
# when_chanted and source still to be written. Verses are complete.
```

The template guards each of those with ``{% if %}``, so the chant renders fine without them — every verse still shows all five layers, and only the chant's context is missing. Grep for COMMENTARY PENDING to find them all later.

At EVERY depth, every verse must carry all five layers — pali, pali_roman, thai, paiboon and english. A verse missing its english is a fault at any depth, not a depth setting. Stop and tell me rather than writing it.

Structure rules

- ONE Pali line per verse, exactly as the JSON gives them. Never merge verses and never split one. Short verses stay short — a chant is read straight down the page, one line chanted then understood.
- 'section' marks where a new titled movement begins. Only the first verse of a section carries it; the template renders it as a heading above that verse.
- Empty strings are meaningful, not missing data. If every field of 'invitation' is "", keep the dict with its empty fields; the template checks it and skips it. If 'source' is "", leave it "". Do not fill any of them in to look complete.
- If you attribute a source yourself, mark it with a `!! UNVERIFIED` comment.

Fidelity rules — these matter more than tidiness

- Copy every Pali, Thai, Paiboon and English string across CHARACTER FOR CHARACTER. Do not fix, tidy, re-space or "improve" any of it. If something looks wrong, add it unchanged and tell me afterwards.
- Do NOT convert the Paiboon into another romanisation. This app uses Paiboon+: `ṇ` never "ng", and `k/t/p` never "kh"/"th"/"ph".
- Watch the encoding: Thai script plus IAST diacritics plus Paiboon+ characters (`ε ɔ ə ʉ ṇ`). Nothing should end up as `?` or mojibake.

Then verify before telling me it's done

Run these with `PYTHONIOENCODING=utf-8` set, or Thai output will crash on Windows.

1. ``python -c "import chanting"`` — it must import cleanly.
2. Confirm `len(CHANTS)` grew by exactly the number of NEW chants — not the number of entries in the batch. Neither a merge nor a continuation may change the count. If the count moved by more than that, a merge or a continuation became an append and there is now a duplicate: stop and tell me.

3. Confirm every id is unique. Two dicts with the same id is the failure this whole merge rule exists to prevent, so check it explicitly rather than assuming.
4. For EACH chant, compare the Thai and Pali you wrote against the JSON I pasted and report character counts both ways. Per chant, not summed — a batch total can balance while two chants are individually wrong.
5. For each MERGED chant, prove the existing text is untouched: dump its verses, titles and invitation before and after, and report the diff as empty. The only permitted change is keys being added.
6. Re-scan the written file for "kh", "th", "ph" and "ng" inside paiboon values only, and report the count. Stage 1 checks itself; this checks stage 1.
7. Check the page numbers read sensibly: within a chant they must not go backwards, and `page\_start` must match the first `page` if the chant has one. Report anything odd rather than adjusting it.
8. PROVE the pages against the map, which is the check the reading view depends on. Walk the chants you wrote and rebuild each verse's page by carrying forward — a verse with no `page` key is on the page of the verse before it, and the first is on `page\_start`. Then compare that against `batch.pages`, verse by verse. Print the disagreements, or print "pages agree: N verses across N pages". If they disagree, do NOT adjust either side to match: show me both and stop. One side is what the photograph said and the other is what went into the app, and I need to know which is wrong before either is trusted.
9. For each CONTINUED chant, confirm the joined verse numbers run 1..N with no gap and no repeat, and that the verse count equals what was there before plus what arrived. Print the join: the last two verses from before and the first two from this batch, so I can see the seam.
10. Render the page and confirm each new chant shows the right verse count, its section headings, its page markers and its layers, and that existing chants are unchanged.

Report THREE tables. I read the tables, not the prose.

Added chants: id, page_start, book_number, verses in, verses written, checks carried, char match y/n.

Merged chants: id, what you added, how many differences you found, and whether the existing text was left intact.

Continued/open: id, verses before, verses added, joined range, and whether the chant is now complete or still carries !! CONTINUES.

Then, separately from the tables, list every page whose number stage 1 could not read and every image it asked me to retake. That is my next job, and it is the one thing here that gets harder the longer it waits — the book will be back on its shelf.

Do not commit. I'll review the batch first.

Here is the batch:

[paste the whole stage 1 reply here — the JSON object and its closing sentence]

Stage 3 — paste into Claude Code, later

The commentary pass, run after a DATA-ONLY batch is in and verified. Nothing to paste with it: the chants are already in chanting.py, so it reads them from there.

Write the missing commentary for chants in the Digital Chanting Book in
~/thaibridge-ai.

Some chants were set at DATA-ONLY depth: their verses are complete and verified, but the chant-level prose was deferred. They are marked with a comment reading "!! COMMENTARY PENDING" at the top of the dict. Your job is to fill in what that comment lists, and nothing else.

Do the first N you find, N being the number I gave you — or 5 if I gave none. Work through them in file order so we can go straight down the book.

SKIP any chant also carrying a `!! CONTINUES` comment, however many are left. That chant is only half in the app: the rest of its verses are on pages I have not photographed yet. Commentary written about half a chant would describe a thing that does not exist, and it would look finished. List the ones you skipped so I know which pages to photograph next.

The one rule that outranks everything else here

DO NOT TOUCH A SINGLE CHARACTER OF ANY VERSE.

`pali`, `pali\_roman`, `thai`, `paiboon` and `english`, the titles, the invitation, the sections, the verse numbers, `page\_start`, the per-verse `page` keys, `book\_number` and the existing `!!` comments have all been verified against a physical book already. They are finished work. You are adding keys to a dict, not editing one.

The page numbers deserve a line of their own: they are the only field a reader meets in public, mid-chant, with a monk calling out a page. A page number you "corrected" is worse than one left alone, whatever it looks like from here.

This is not a style preference. Verified Pali that quietly changes is the single worst outcome this whole workflow is built to prevent, and it would not look wrong afterwards. If you think a verse is mistaken, say so in your report and leave it exactly as it is.

What to write

For each chant, add these five keys, in this position and this order — matching the existing chants in the file, which are the shape to copy:

summary — ONE sentence, max 30 words, for the closed index card. What this chant is, plainly, to someone who has not met it.
when_chanted — ONE sentence on when it is recited in Theravāda practice.
source — the canonical source. Read the rules below before writing it.
background — a LIST of paragraphs. Why was it taught? The historical setting, or the origin of the chant if composed later.
meaning — a LIST of paragraphs. What does it mean, and why is it still chanted?

`background` and `meaning` are lists of strings, one per paragraph, never one long string — the page and a printed edition space them from that structure. Two or three paragraphs each is right. Do not pad them to look thorough.

Where your material comes from

Work from the chant that is in front of you in the file. It has the Pali, the Thai and the English of every verse, which is what the commentary is about.

You may use general knowledge of Theravāda practice and of the Pali canon for context — that is what `background` is for, and it is why this pass is a writing job rather than a transcription one. But there is a hard line:

- NEVER quote, reconstruct or "restore" any Pali or Thai that is not already in the file. Not a line, not a phrase, not a word. If a point would need a verse the chant does not contain, make the point without it or leave it out.
- NEVER contradict the chant in front of you because a standard edition differs. The file follows Josh's physical book. Where they disagree, the book wins, and you say so in your report rather than editing anything.

`source` — the field most likely to go wrong

Attributing a canonical source is exactly where a confident invention slips through, because a plausible reference looks identical to a real one.

- If you are certain, write it (`Dhammapada 188–192`, `Khuddakapāṭha 5`).
- If it is assembled from several places, start with `Composite.` and say which parts come from where.
- If you are NOT certain, write `""`. An empty source is honest and the template simply omits it. A wrong one is a false citation in a book about the Dhamma.
- Any source YOU attribute, rather than one already in the file, gets a comment directly above it:

!! UNVERIFIED SOURCE: attributed by Claude, not taken from Josh's book.

Never write that comment above a source that was already there.

Register — this is the part that has to match

The app's existing chants set the register, so read two or three finished ones before you write anything. Dignified and plain. Closer to "Having gone to such a refuge, one is freed from all suffering" than "Once you take this refuge you won't suffer". No devotional inflation, no self-help framing, no exclamation marks, and no addressing the reader as "you".

Write for someone intelligent who does not know Buddhism. Explain a Pali term the first time it appears in that chant's prose, then use it.

When you are done with each chant

Replace the whole COMMENTARY PENDING comment — do not leave it sitting above a chant that now has its commentary. That marker is how Josh finds the remaining work, so a stale one is worse than none.

If you could only do part of a chant — say the source is genuinely unknowable — leave a narrowed marker instead of removing it:

!! COMMENTARY PENDING: source only. Could not attribute with confidence.

Then verify before telling me it's done

Run with PYTHONIOENCODING=utf-8 set, or Thai output will crash on Windows.

1. `python -c "import chanting"` — it must import cleanly.
2. PROVE the verses are untouched. Before you edit, dump every verse of every chant to a file; after you edit, dump them again and diff the two. Report the diff as empty. Do the same for the titles and the invitation. If ANYTHING shows up in that diff, stop and show me — do not tidy it away.
3. Confirm len(CHANTS) is unchanged and every id is unchanged.
4. Confirm background and meaning are lists of strings for every chant you touched, not bare strings.

5. Count COMMENTARY PENDING markers before and after, and report both numbers.
The drop should equal the number of chants you completed.
6. Render the page and confirm each chant now shows its context sections, and that the chants you did NOT touch look exactly as they did.

Report as a table: id, paragraphs written for background, paragraphs for meaning, source written or left empty, marker cleared y/n.

Then tell me, separately from the table, anything you noticed but did not act on — a verse that looks wrong, a chant whose source you could not place, a duplicate of one earlier in the file.

Do not commit. I'll read the prose before it goes in.

Before you say it is done

The canonical copy of both prompts is prompts/chanting-book-batch/prompt.md in the repo — copy from there, not from this sheet, which folds long lines to fit the page and prints !! where the prompt uses the warning emoji.

Count the manifest against the entries that actually arrived. A reply cut off mid-array still parses as JSON, so nothing downstream will notice on your behalf — and nothing written at the end of a reply can report it, because in a truncated reply the end is exactly what is missing. That is why the manifest comes first.

Check the character counts Stage 2 reports, both ways: every Thai and Pali character from your paste should appear in the file, and none should appear that was not in your paste. That the page loads and the file imports proves neither.